

MODULE 2

# A named plan for the middle-layer role shift

The AI-First Delivery Lifecycle

Workshop deliverable · template

# The middle-layer bottleneck

When developers go 5x faster, Product Owners, BAs and PMs become the constraint — they can't spec, break down, and coordinate at the new pace. The answer isn't to remove the roles; it's to redefine them around specification and intent.

## Role shift

| ROLE                         | FROM                            | TO                                                 |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Product Owner                | Ticket writer / backlog groomer | Spec owner — defines intent AI can execute against |
| Business Analyst             | Requirements gatherer           | Requirements-prompt engineer; contract definer     |
| Programme / Delivery Manager | Status coordinator              | Flow & dependency manager across faster cycles     |

## The plan

- › Name who moves into each redefined role (people, not just titles).
- › Give them the spec template and coach them on it (Module 2).
- › Set the expectation: specs are now a first-class deliverable.
- › Define how POs/BAs and engineers collaborate on contracts up front.
- › Review after 4–6 weeks: is the middle layer keeping pace now?

### Owner & date

Role-shift owner: \_\_\_\_ · First review: \_\_\_\_